

OUTLIERS

The Meeting Agent

It logs into Fathom, files every call you have, and writes down what was decided and what was promised.

You do nothing.

A S H L E Y D E A N S M I T H

FOR MAC

SECTION 1

What this is

You watched this run on the webinar. Here it is.

It opens a browser by itself, logs into Fathom, finds the calls you have not dealt with yet, and pulls each transcript in. Then it writes up what happened: what was decided, what was promised and by whom, everyone who got named, and whatever was left hanging. No hands, as I said on the call.

A call you had in March has gone by May unless somebody wrote it down.

SECTION 2

The one condition, said up front

READ THIS BEFORE YOU DOWNLOAD ANYTHING

This agent does not work on its own. It writes into a second brain, and if you have not got one there is nowhere for it to put anything.

I know how that reads. You came for a free agent and the first page is telling you about something else you need first. Fair enough.

I am not selling you anything here. The agent is a filing clerk and that is the whole of what it is, and filing needs somewhere to put the paper.

A second brain is a folder of plain text files on your own computer with everything your business knows inside it. Section 3 is what that looks like in practice, and section 4 gives you 2 ways to get one.

If you already keep notes in Obsidian, or Logseq, or honestly just a folder of text files, you have got one. Go to section 5 and install the agent.

What a second brain is, and why it is worth an afternoon

Almost none of this is about software. What makes it work is that everything sits in 1 place, in a format you and an AI can both read.

Every client, every call, every decision, every promise, every idea, in 1 folder of plain text files on your machine. Claude reads it and writes to it.

WHAT THAT ACTUALLY BUYS YOU

On the webinar I opened a client's page in my notes and showed the room every call I have ever had with him, going back months. Not a summary of them either, the actual record, down to what he said and what I said and what each of us agreed to do. I did not type a word of it. The agent in this guide put it there while I was doing something else.

There are over 500 calls filed the same way behind him.

YOU STOP PAYING FOR ADMIN

I used to pay a monthly fee for a CRM so that I could do data entry into a system I had to learn first. Pay, every month, to do my own admin, until the second brain took it over.

NOTHING LIVES ONLY IN YOUR HEAD OR YOUR INBOX

The most valuable material in most businesses gets said out loud on a call and is then gone by the end of the week, and nobody notices until they need the detail of what was agreed and nobody wrote it down. With the agent running, that call is in the folder the same day, and you can search it 3 years later.

IT GETS BETTER THE LONGER YOU USE IT

Early on it is a folder with a handful of notes in it and you will wonder why you bothered. Leave it running and it becomes the first place you look before a call, because by then it knows more about your own business than you can keep in your head.

YOU OWN IT

They are plain text files sitting on your own computer. Nothing to subscribe to, and no company that can put its prices up or disappear. If you stopped using every tool named in this guide tomorrow, you would still have the files.

An AI that can read 200 of your own calls answers you about your actual clients, in your actual words. It is the same model you are already paying for. The difference is what it is allowed to read.

WHERE PEOPLE GO WRONG WITH THIS

Building one takes an afternoon. Most people who fail at it spend 3 weeks designing a perfect structure and never put anything in it.

Start it ugly and put a real call in on day 1.

SECTION 4

2 ways to get one

Build it yourself from the addresses on the next page, which costs nothing but your time. Or take mine, which is already built and already works with the agent in this guide.

SECTION 4, CONTINUED

WAY 1 / BUILD YOUR OWN

Some people would sooner understand it by making it, because you end up knowing where everything is. These are the starting points I would actually send someone.

READ	WHAT IT GIVES YOU
obsidian.md	The app most people build one in. Free, and the files stay on your computer
help.obsidian.md	The official set-up instructions, start to finish
buildingasecondbrain.com	Tiago Forte. He named the idea, and his is the method most people meet first
linkingyourthinking.com	Nick Milo. Better than Forte on how notes connect to each other
zettelkasten.de	The 70-year-old paper method all of this came from. Worth an hour
notes.andymatuschak.org	A working example you can read: his notes about note-taking, inside the system
logseq.com	The main alternative to Obsidian, if you prefer an outline to a page

WATCH	WHY
youtube.com/@TiagoForte	The method explained by the man who wrote the book on it
youtube.com/@linkingyourthinking	Nick Milo. The most practical channel on actually organising one
youtube.com/@ashleydeansmith	Mine. How I use it inside a business, with the agents running on top

ALL 10 ADDRESSES OPENED AND CHECKED 18 SEPTEMBER 2026

Start with Obsidian's own set-up page and 1 video. Not all 10. The afternoon goes on deciding what the folders are called, and every one of those decisions is one you will change twice.

SECTION 4, CONTINUED

WAY 2 / TAKE MINE, ALREADY BUILT

The second brain I run my own business out of is not on the internet and I am not putting it there. It goes to people in the Outliers Guild.

There are 5 assistants that come with it, and they are the reason the folder fills up without you typing. Each one fills a second brain system in a different way.

ASSISTANT	WHAT ARRIVES	WHAT IT GIVES YOU BACK
the-archivist	Documents	Contracts, reports, proposals, anything of length. Turns them into clean notes and flags anything committing you to a future action, so a deadline on page 9 does not stay buried
the-librarian	Books and courses	Captures ideas on the author's own terms, deliberately without bending them to fit what you already believe, because that is how you lose the parts that disagree with you
the-scribe	Anything spoken	A transcript, rough notes, a recording. Gives back what was decided, what was promised and by whom, what was learned, and who was mentioned
the-researcher	The web	Research saved with its sources, dated, showing where sources disagree instead of quietly picking one
the-curator	Housekeeping	Reconciles anything that contradicts itself and merges duplicates, working from the original note instead of its own previous tidy-up

The meeting agent in this guide is the 6th, and it is the smallest of them. It only does Fathom. Those 5 take everything else.

Then you get shown how it is actually run across a working week, in a room with other business owners setting theirs up at the same time.

Before you start on a Mac

Python. Install Python from <https://www.python.org/downloads/macos/> (the link labelled "macOS installer"; we tested 3.14.7). When it finishes, double-click **Install Certificates.command** and **Update Shell Profile.command** in the Python folder inside Applications, then open a new Terminal window. Check with:

```
python3 -c "import sys; print(sys.prefix)"
```

It should print a line starting **/Library/Frameworks/Python.framework**. If it starts **/opt/homebrew** or **/usr/local/Cellar**, your Terminal uses Homebrew's Python (Homebrew is an add-on installer many Mac owners use). Every line in this guide works with either Python. Playwright, the add-on that drives the browser, is installed into a private Python folder called **.venv** inside the download (step 3): a folder with its own copy of Python's add-ons.

The first time you type git. Your Mac may show a box asking to install the command line developer tools. Press Install, wait until it has finished, then type the git line again.

After step 1 on the next page, if Terminal says claude is not found, type the line below. It adds the folder Claude Code is installed in to the list of folders Terminal looks in for programs. Then open a new Terminal window and check with **claude --version**.

```
echo 'export PATH="$HOME/.local/bin:$PATH"' >> ~/.zshrc
```

Apple Silicon or Intel (the 2 kinds of chip a Mac can have; the Apple menu, then About This Mac, shows yours): the steps are the same on both, and both were tested.

Tried only on test Macs. Every step in this guide was tried on test Macs (Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script), apart from the steps the last page marks as not tried. No step was tried on a real Mac.

Installing the agent

STEP 1 / GET CLAUDE CODE

It is at **claude.ai/code**. This is an agent that Claude runs, not a program you double-click. It needs a Claude Pro or Max plan. There is no free route to this one, and I would sooner say so here than let you find out at step 4.

STEP 2 / DOWNLOAD THE AGENT

Git is the tool programmers use to copy code. Open Terminal and run this:

```
git clone https://github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/fathom-meeting-agent-mac.git
```

If the developer-tools box will not install, open that same address without the **.git** on the end, press the green Code button, and download the zip instead. If it stays a zip file in Downloads, double-click it to unzip it.

STEP 3 / INSTALL THE BROWSER

The agent reads Fathom the way you do, through a real browser, because Fathom has no free way in for software. Go into the folder you downloaded in Step 2, make a private Python folder called **.venv** in it (the dot at the start means Finder hides it), install Playwright into it, then the browser Playwright drives:

```
cd fathom-meeting-agent-mac
python3 -m venv .venv
source .venv/bin/activate && python -m pip install playwright
source .venv/bin/activate && python -m playwright install chromium
```

If you used the zip, the folder is called **fathom-meeting-agent-mac-main** and is in your Downloads folder: type this in place of the first line (the zip route was not tried on the test Macs):

```
cd ~/Downloads/fathom-meeting-agent-mac-main
```

Each line that starts with source switches Terminal into the **.venv** folder first, so the python after && is the folder's own copy. Playwright, an add-on that lets a program drive a web browser, is free and made by Microsoft. The last line downloads Chromium, the free browser Google Chrome is built from; Playwright keeps it in its own folder, **~/Library/Caches/ms-playwright**, not in **.venv**. About 330 to 350MB in all (measured on test Macs). The agent looks for Playwright in **.venv**.

SECTION 5, CONTINUED

STEP 4 / LOG INTO FATHOM YOURSELF, BY HAND, ONCE

THIS IS THE STEP EVERYONE MISSES

In the same Terminal window, still in that folder, open the browser Playwright just installed, with the line under this box.

Log in exactly as you normally would. **Take as long as you need.** Nothing is counting down. Nothing. Go and find your password, wait for a code, make a cup of tea. Then close the browser. The login stays in the **.browser-profile** folder and you will not do this again.

```
source .venv/bin/activate && python -m playwright open --user-data-dir=.browser-profile https://fathom.video
```

Your agent never sees your password. It never types one and it never stores one. If anything ever asks you to hand a password to an agent, stop, because something is wrong.

STEP 5 / OPEN CLAUDE CODE INSIDE THE FOLDER AND SAY:

In the same Terminal window, still in that folder, type **claude** and press Return, then say:

```
check Fathom
```

That is it. Afterwards any of these work: *any new calls?* / *process my meetings* / *triage my recordings*.

What you get back

One file per call, named by date and who was on it. Each one opens with a plain account of the call, above the full transcript.

- **What this meeting was.** 1 line
- **What happened.** The facts, in order
- **Decisions made.** Only what was actually decided. If nothing was, it says so
- **What was promised, by whom, and by when.** The most valuable section on the page
- **People mentioned.** Every name, linked to their own note
- **Anything unresolved.** The questions left hanging

Everyone on the call also gets their own note, with this meeting added to their history. So you open a person and see every call you have ever had with them, and what each of you said you would do. That builds itself while you get on with your week.

What it will not do

It writes what happened, not what it means. No read on how the call went and no guess at whether the deal closes. You read the facts in 6 months and make your own mind up.

It never invents to fill a gap. Transcripts are frequently wrong. Speakers get mislabelled and whole passages garble. Where the transcript is unclear it says so and quotes the mess as it found it. It will not smooth a broken passage into a clean sentence nobody said, because that is exactly how a promise nobody made ends up in someone's permanent record.

Anything commercial goes in word for word. Prices, dates, terms and anything resembling an agreement are quoted exactly, never put in other words.

It files and links. That is all. It never replies to anyone and it never acts on a commitment it found.

If you do not use Fathom

The agent is built around 1 service on purpose. Login pages and page layouts are different everywhere, and a tool that half-works on 5 services is worse than one that works properly on 1.

So on Otter, Granola, tl;dv or Zoom's own recordings, the collecting half will not work. **The filing half still does.** A second agent called the Scribe comes in the same download. Export the transcript from wherever you record, paste it in, and you get the same record with the same links. One manual step instead of none.

Where to stop

Practical limits, not moral ones.

Read, do not act. Have it collect and file. Do not extend it to click anything that sends, posts, buys or messages on your behalf. The moment automation acts outwardly, a mistake is public and you cannot take it back.

Your account, your consequences. Automating a service may be against the terms you agreed to, and enforcement usually means losing the account without a warning first. Your judgement to make, service by service, and the risk is yours.

One job at a time, at human pace. Anything hammering a site quickly looks like exactly what it is. Slow is fine. These jobs run while you are doing something else.

Never point it at somebody else's account.

If you need further support come join OUTLIERS Guild.

EVERYTHING IN THIS GUIDE

github.com/OUTLIERS-ai/fathom-meeting-agent-mac / the agent
Outliers Guild / the second brain it was built inside, already set up

What was run on a Mac

A **test Mac** is one of the Macs GitHub rents out by the minute to run a script.

Mac test for this version not yet recorded.

NOT RUN ON THE TEST MACS

The Fathom login. Step 4 opens a browser for you to log into Fathom by hand, which a script cannot do, so the agent never collected a call on a test Mac. The same line with a blank page in place of Fathom's address was run, and the browser opened.

The box asking to install the developer tools (page 7) and the zip route (page 8).